

YOUR PROFESSIONAL RECORD

The copyable working document (Stage 2, for review)

Companion to Keep the Proof, Version 2. Prepared for Temidayo Afonja, The Density Group.
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This is the complete specification of the Professional Record: every section, field, prompt, and instruction, and how the optional printable and fillable pages relate to it. It is for review only, not final design. The Professional Record replaces the separate Career Evidence Ledger as the primary long-term working home and absorbs its useful fields and prompts, so nothing from the Ledger is lost.

Design note for the build stage, not reader-facing: the Record is delivered as a plain, widely readable, copyable document the reader owns and duplicates. It is platform-neutral by decision. No app, spreadsheet, or service is named or required, because the evidence for any single choice is not there. Reader-facing instructions below refer to "your copy," never to a named product.

How to use your Professional Record

This is your record, not a form to submit. Make one copy that belongs only to you, keep it somewhere you control and your employer does not own, and add to it over time. It holds everything the guide produces, in one searchable place.

- Make it yours. Save your own copy in a personal account, protected with a unique password and multifactor authentication.
- Keep it in one place. One record you maintain beats four you abandon.
- Permission first. Everything in here follows the one rule: your own recollection and what you are permitted to keep. Never paste in employer-owned files or confidential detail.
- Fill only what applies. A short, honest entry beats a padded one. Blank fields are fine.

The record has six sections: a Capture Log, Full Entries, a Corroboration list, a Translation and Proof Line workspace, an Evidence Index, and two optional maintenance checklists. Each is specified below with its exact prompts.

Section 1. Capture Log

Purpose: catch work the moment it happens, in two minutes, before the details soften. Add one row per event. This is the fast layer; you expand only the strongest into Full Entries.

For each capture, the five prompts:

- What happened? The event or piece of work, in a line.
- What was my specific contribution or judgment? My part, not the team's.
- What changed, improved, became possible, or was prevented? The consequence.
- Verifier role or permitted public reference. A role or a public source that could confirm it. No personal contact details.
- Confidential detail to keep out. Named, so I remember to leave it out.

Optional per row: the date, and a trigger tag from the capture-event list (project ended, scope changed, praise or feedback, problem escalated, risk prevented, leadership changed, inherited difficult work, decision under uncertainty, measurable result appeared, team changed, responsibility expanded).

Section 2. Full Entries

Purpose: for work worth keeping in depth, expand a capture into a full entry. Repeat this structure once per entry. Fill only the fields that apply; a strong entry with six good fields beats a padded one with sixteen. The fields are grouped into five clusters that follow the shape of a good account.

Cluster A. When and what. – Date or period. – Project or work event. – Situation or need. The problem or condition you were responding to. – Why it mattered. What was at stake if it went unaddressed.

Cluster B. What was actually yours. – Formal responsibility. What you were assigned on paper. – Actual ownership. What you truly drove, which is often different. – Scope and constraint. Scale, complexity, or the limits you worked within. – People and functions involved. Who you worked with or influenced, by role.

Cluster C. The judgment inside it. – Decision or judgment exercised. The call you made, and the options you weighed. – Actions taken. What you actually did.

Cluster D. What changed, and what supports it. – Outcome or observable change. What was observably different afterward. – Problem prevented. The cost, delay, or risk that did not land. Use "would likely have," not "definitely would have." – Quantitative evidence, accurate and permitted. Numbers only when accurate and permitted. Never invented. – Qualitative evidence or validation. Feedback, recognition, or credible validation. – Team result versus your honest part. The shared outcome, and your honest share of it.

Cluster E. How you would say it, and who could confirm it. – Internal wording, before translation. – Portable-language version. – Who could corroborate this, by role, and what they directly observed. Role and observation only; no personal contact details. – Permitted evidence reference. Name the permitted source or location. Do not paste the artifact or confidential content. – Confidentiality

and permission check. Confirmed nothing restricted is being kept. – Retrieval tags. Review, promotion, compensation, resume, interview, biography, transition.

Reconstruction marker, used only when rebuilding after access loss: label the entry, or any field in it, as Known, Supported, Remembered but not verified, or Uncertain, so a memory is never presented as a fact.

Section 3. Corroboration list

Purpose: keep, in one place, who could confirm your work while they still remember it. This is corroboration readiness, not networking. It records that a witness exists and what they saw. It does not decide any employer's choice.

For each entry worth corroborating: – The work it refers to. A short label linking to the Full Entry. – Who could confirm it, by role. For example, "the operations manager I partnered with." Not a stored personal contact record. – What they directly observed. The specific thing this person saw or worked on with you.

Instruction: keep this to role and observation. Do not store private contact details or personal information about the colleague inside your record. This list prepares you to reach the right person with specifics later, through your own means, if a moment ever calls for it.

Note for the build stage, not reader-facing: LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED on any wording about capturing a named person's observations and on privacy. This section stores role and observation only. Final wording confirmed with counsel.

Section 4. Translation and Proof Line workspace

Purpose: turn internal language into portable language, and build the portable sentence you can reuse. Absorbed from the Ledger's translation worksheet and Proof Line builder.

Translation worksheet. For an entry you are translating, work down the eight moves and apply the ones that fit, then the protection rule: – Name to function. – Assignment to contribution. – Activity to consequence. – Team to your part. – Acronym to meaning. – "Helped with" to real role. – No number to credible detail. – Number to scale. – Sensitive to permitted (protection rule): if the only accurate version would expose something you may not keep, omit it rather than reword it.

Keep any team result separate from your own part throughout.

Proof Line builder. Combine, in whatever order reads well, up to five ingredients into one portable sentence: – The condition. The problem or situation you were responding to. – Your part. The contribution, decision, or judgment that was yours. – The scope or constraint. The size or limits

you worked within. – The outcome. What changed, or what was prevented. – The support.
Permitted evidence or validation, when you have it.

Rule: a Proof Line does not need a number, must never contain an invented one, and never claims sole credit for a shared result.

Proof Lines kept. A running list of your finished Proof Lines, so they are ready to pull for a review, a resume, or a conversation.

Section 5. Evidence Index

Purpose: a running list of what you have, so any entry is a search away. Absorbed from the Ledger's Quarterly Evidence Index and made a living index rather than a quarterly task.

For each entry, one line: a short title, the date or period, the function or role, the retrieval tags, and, when rebuilding, its highest certainty level. Update it whenever you add or revise an entry, and read it when a moment arrives and you need the right material fast.

Section 6. Optional maintenance checklists

Purpose: for readers who want a rhythm in addition to event-based capture. Neither is required; you can run on event capture alone. Absorbed from the Ledger's Monthly Proof Sweep and Quarterly Proof Review, and marked optional here per the Version 2 decision that cadence is not settled.

Monthly, about ten to fifteen minutes. – Look back over the month's projects, decisions, feedback, changes, and problems you helped prevent. – Add Quick Captures for anything worth keeping. – Expand the single most significant item into a Full Entry. – Run the confidentiality check: is everything here permitted? – Tag each item for retrieval.

Quarterly, about thirty minutes. – Read the quarter's entries in one sitting. – Remove duplicates and anything too vague to be useful. – Correct overstatement and add missing context while you still remember. – Translate the strongest entries into Proof Lines. – Note where evidence is thin, without drawing any conclusion about your career from the gap. – Update the Evidence Index.

This is housekeeping, not a verdict. It organizes and translates what happened; it does not tell you what your career means.

Printable and fillable companion structure

Some readers prefer to write by hand or type into a form. The printable and fillable pages are an option, not a separate system, and they hold exactly the same fields as the Professional Record above.

What remains available as optional companion pages: – A printable and fillable Quick Capture, one capture per page. – A printable and fillable Full Entry, carrying the five clusters across its pages. – A printable Translation and Proof Line page. – Printable Monthly and Quarterly checklists, for readers who use the routines.

How they relate to the Professional Record: – Same fields, same prompts, same order. Nothing in the companion pages is unique to them; they are a paper or PDF face of the same record. – The Professional Record is the recommended long-term home, because it is searchable, copyable, and easy to maintain over years. The companion pages exist so a reader who prefers paper, or a fillable PDF, loses nothing. – A reader can start on paper and move into the copyable Record later, or keep both. The discipline is identical; only the medium differs.

What is deliberately not here. No field invites employer-owned artifacts. No section performs destination-specific targeting, direction, or stay-or-leave analysis. Those are outside the Professional Record by design.

END OF PROFESSIONAL RECORD SPECIFICATION